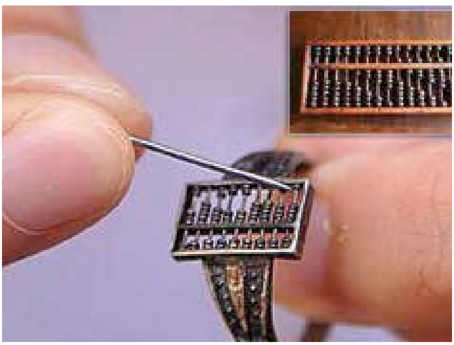
by an employee in a given unit of time. This scenario meant that during the early years after time keeping was introduced, devices to accurately mark time became important.

Of these, the Nuremberg Egg was one that the owner could wear around the neck. A predecessor of the pocket watch that was to become popular in the later centuries, the Nuremberg Egg was in vogue during the early 16th century. The users were particularly impressed by the fact that these devices made use of clockwork rather than weights like the preceding moidels of time-keeping units.

The invention of the device is credited to German clockmaker, Peter Heinlin.

The Abacus Ring- the 'calculating wearable machine' of the 17th century

Some people consider it the first ever wearable computer. Others see it as a novelty item introduced in humanity's past. Whatever be the case, there exists no doubt that the Abacus Ring-invented in China during the 16th century, was a major evolutinary point in the history of wearables.



Calculating with fingers, taken to another level

The ring which was developed during the early years of the Qing Dynasty(1644 to 1911) was 1.2 cm long and 0.7 cm wide and could be worn on a finger.

Having seven rods with seven beads each, the ring was mostly used by Chinese ladies who used hairpins to move the bead since the manuever was impossible to make using a finger, owing to the diminutive size of the beads.

The users could make quick calculations using the Chinese abacus which had a value of 10 or a multiple or sub multiple of the number ascribed to each bead. For instance, all beads on a single rod could have the value of 1. If that's the case and you have to represent, say the number 155, you should separate five beads on a rod from the rest of them on the 'ten's wire and also separate a bead on the 'hundreds' wire. The traditional Chinese abacus had